

Samsung Noodles

In the 1930s, the present day Samsung used to sell noodles and food products

Apple iPhone 4 India

Bharti Airtel and Aircel have announced they will bring Apple iPhone 4 to India "in the coming months"

HTC launches Incredible S, Desire S smartphones, tablets and more

HTC has launched the Incredible S and Desire S smartphone in India, both of which feature Android 2.3 Gingerbread, and updated specifications from their predecessors. The HTC Incredible S was launched in India with a Super LCD screen, and was priced at ₹28,990 (MRP). The HTC Desire S was launched with a price of ₹25,490.

The HTC Desire S has the same aluminium unibody style as the HTC Desire, the same 3.7-inch SuperLCD screen with Gorilla Glass, and the same autofocus 5MP camera, also capable of 720p HD video recording.

It features the updated Qualcomm MSM8255 chipset, with a new 1 GHz Scorpion processor and Adreno 205 GPU. It also has a slightly larger battery, at 1450 mAh, and more RAM at 768MB, but, HTC

has done away with the original Desire's optical trackpad.

The HTC Incredible S has the same large 4-inch display as the HTC Incredible, this time coming with Super LCD to India. It also has Qualcomm's updated MSM8255 chipset, featuring a 1GHz Scorpion processor, and the Adreno 205 GPU. It operates on 768 MB of RAM, and 1.1 GB of ROM. It has an 8 MP autofocus camera onboard, equipped with dual-LED flash and image stabilisation, which is also capable of recording 720p HD

video at 30 frames per second. It also has a secondary front-facing 1.3MP camera for video calls.



HTC also announced a new glasses-free (autostereoscopic) 3D Android phone, called HTC EVO 3D. It has a massive 4.3-inch qHD display with a resolution of 540x960 pixels. It has two 5MP cameras on the back, to capture 3D video and images. Video recording is up to 720p HD, and, still 3D image capture is up to 2MP in resolution. It features a 1.2GHz dual-core CPU just like HTC Sensation, except this is part of the MSM8660 chipset, with an Adreno 220 GPU onboard as well. It comes with 1GB of RAM.

HTC introduced a new tablet as well, which is identical to the HTC Flyer, except, it bears both CDMA and WiMAX radios, and, its aluminium unibody is black instead of the silver of the Flyer. It bears the same specs all around – the same 1.5GHz single-core processor, Gingerbread OS, and 1024x600-pixel screen. ■

Amazon better than Android

In a move that still shocks with its temerity, Amazon has launched the Amazon Appstore for Android, meant for both phones and tablets. Including free as well as paid apps, the online retail giant supposedly decided on Google's mobile platform because of its rapid growth and open nature.

According to Amazon, the very 'rapid growth' of the platform implies that consumers are hard-pressed to discover apps that suit them on the Android Market – and with Amazon's long experience in the online retail segment, it can help shoppers better. Rumours of an upcoming Android-based



Kindle device or an Amazon-branded Android tablet also fit seamlessly into the strategy.

Amazon has also taken the onus of testing each app for malicious code before listing it on their store. The store will also only list applications that comply to its content guidelines, implying that it will be clean of adult/pornographic material, unlike the Android Market. Amazon Appstore also offers its own one-click payment options that people might just prefer to Google Checkout. Prices will also be competitive with Android Market rates. The Amazon Appstore will also feature one paid app available for free daily. For more details, go to <http://bit.ly/h7TcOF>. ■

MTS offers Android-based HTC Pulse free with one year contract in India

MTS has launched its first CDMA smartphone in the market, the Android 2.1-based HTC Pulse, which also happens to be the first operator-subsidized smartphone in the country – it comes free with a one year contract that has a post-paid monthly data plan of ₹1,500.

With the plan, users will get 1,500 minutes of talk time, 1,500 messages and 1,500MB of data every month for the first 12 months. The phone can also be

purchased separately from MTS for ₹18,000.

The HTC Pulse doesn't shine brightly in the face of its competitors, but for free, it will definitely attract those not looking to spend on a smartphone, but want one nonetheless. It has a 528 MHz Qualcomm MSM7600 processor, 256MB RAM and 512MB ROM, a 5 MP camera, and 3.1 MBps CDMA EVDO 3G connectivity. Its 3-inch capacitive touch-



screen has a 320x480 resolution. The phone also supports microSD cards up to 32 GB. The phone has a 1300 mAh Li-ion battery that is rated to deliver up to 3 hours and 34 minutes of talk-time, and a standby time of 373 hours. It weighs 120 grams.

Apart from the usual Android ecosystem on offer, users can also use Apalya for mobile TV, a service MTS has tied up with. ■